

PORTLAND
Public Schools

Climate Crisis Response Committee

PPS's Climate Crisis Response Policy

Two Overarching Objectives:

1. **Emissions Reduction:** PPS will reduce its greenhouse gas emissions by 50 percent by 2030, using the 2018-2019 school year baseline, and reach net zero emissions by 2040.

1. **Engagement, Resilience, and Wellness:** The District will take steps to prepare schools for the effects of climate change, and will ensure staff and students learn about and engage in climate solutions, climate resiliency, and climate justice practices.

Three Pillars:

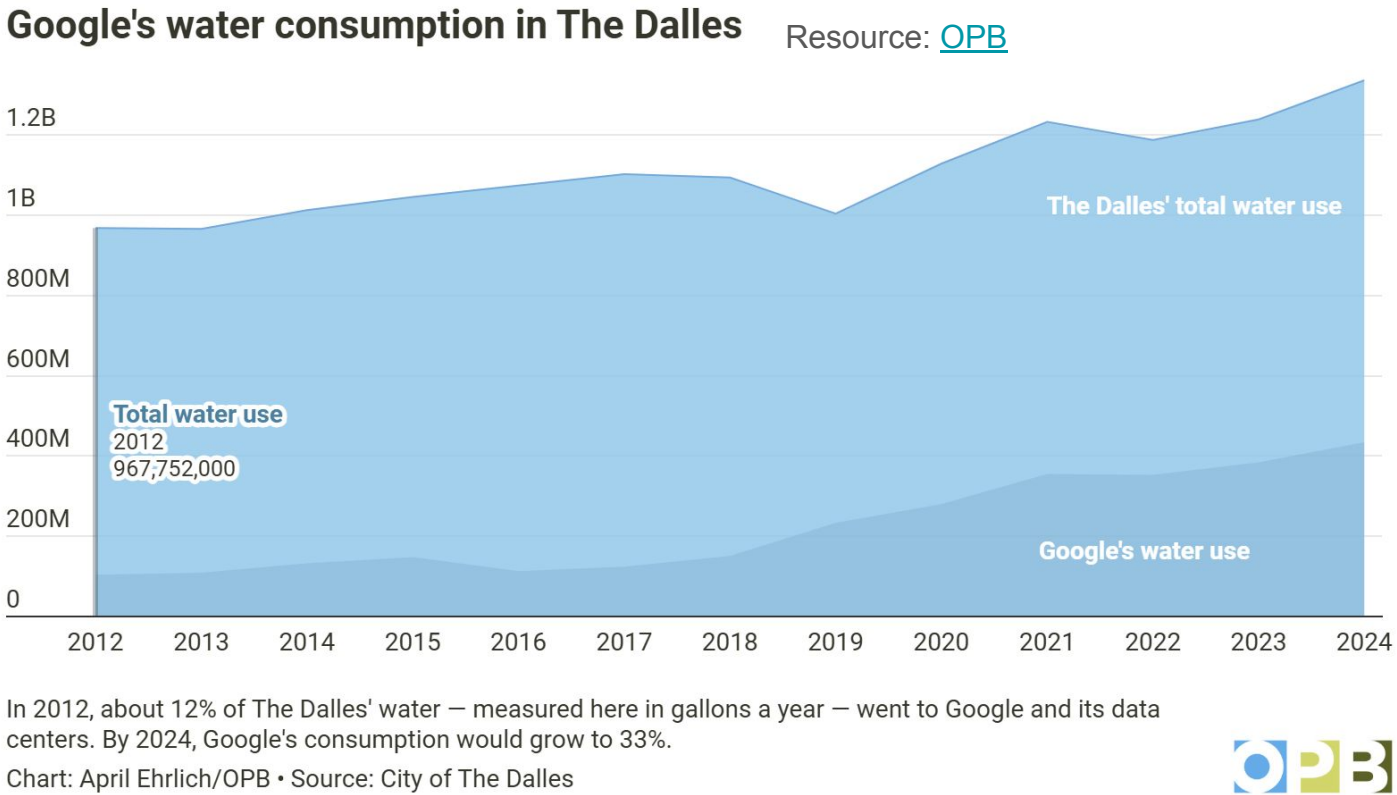
1. Reduce Environmental Impact & Costs
2. Improve Health and Wellness
3. Provide Effective Environmental & Sustainability Education

AI Draft Recommendations - General

In general, the CCRC is in favor of limiting AI use by PPS students and staff as much as possible *due to the negative environmental impact*. The committee suggests tracking, monitoring, and codifying district AI usage so we can quantify environmental impact to facilitate this goal. This data should be made publicly available for use in further climate impact projects.

“A single modern AI data center can use as much power as 100,000 homes; many of the larger ones now being built are expected to consume up to 20 times that amount.” *World Resources Institute*

AI Draft Recommendations - Environment



AI Draft Recommendations - Contracts

The committee also recommends increasing transparency about AI environmental impact by adding language to technology contracts that disclose the environmental impacts of AI and technology usage or provide carbon offsets (Pillar 1 of CCRP).

AI environmental impacts fall under Scope 3 emissions because they are supply chain emissions.

“Every kilowatt-hour used by AI carries carbon, water, and land implications and these footprints do not always move in the same direction: low-carbon electricity is not automatically low-water or low-land.” *United Nations University Institute for Water, Environment and Health*

AI Draft Recommendations - Education

The CCRC recommends requiring education in classrooms (Pillar 3 of CCRP) to accompany any AI use about:

- water use impact,
- energy use impact,
- climate impact,
- resource extraction,
- and impact on local and global communities

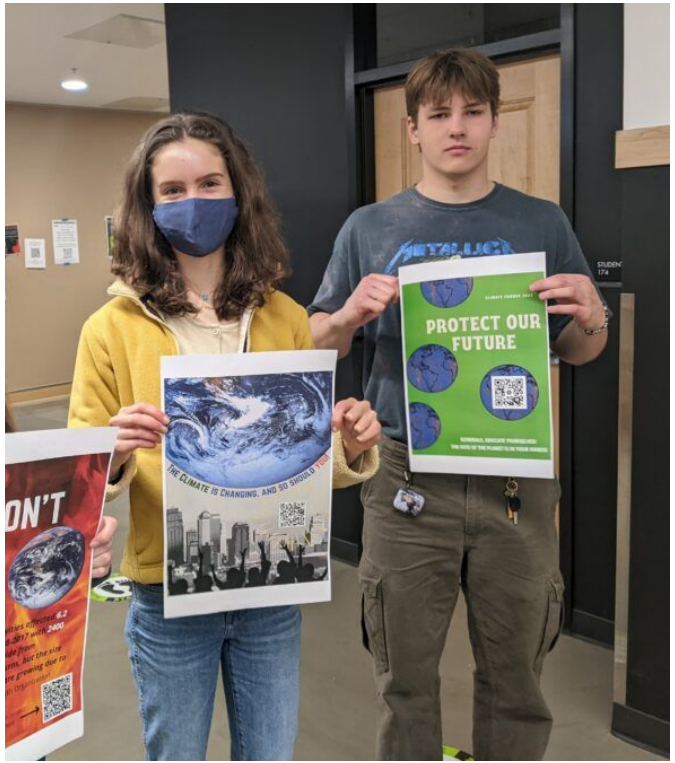
Oregon House Bill 3365 mandates that climate change and sustainability standards be woven into the standard seven-year review cycle for the following subjects: Science, Health, and Social Sciences. CCRC recommends that education of AI impacts be added within the development of this curriculum.

AI Draft Recommendations - Engagement

The CCRC advocates for a designated group of community members and stakeholders, including PPS students, staff, and board members, to create a local consortium around AI for the benefit of the greater Portland community.

Additionally, we recommend formalizing the relationship between the CCRC/PPS Climate Team and the AI Governance Committee, potentially including a CCRC Representative on AI Governance Committee and/or an annual joint meeting.

Thank you!



The CCRC/PPS Climate Team thanks the AI Governance Committee for your commitment and contributions towards making PPS a national climate education leader!

Image Source: Green Schools National Network